

DESIGN CODE NS 10

NOVALITY STORE

Designed by Novality Crochet Studio



Willow the Bunny Lovey

A bunny comforter: a soft, firmly stuffed head above a light, drapey granny-square blanket. Long floppy ears to hold, an embroidered face with no small parts, and a blanket that grows evenly from the centre out.

No small parts

Advanced beginner

2 - 3 hours

FINISHED SIZE

Blanket about 26 cm (10 in) square (20 rounds); head about 4.9 cm across; roughly 33 cm from ear tips to the opposite corner. DK cotton on a 3.5 mm hook (3.0 mm for the head if your tension is loose).

Before You Begin

SAFETY - A BABY ITEM, READ THIS

No safety eyes, buttons, beads or removable parts; the face is embroidered and every floss end is knotted inside the head. That is safer, but it is not a tested toy – do not describe Willow as "baby-safe" without ASTM F963 / EN 71 testing. Comforters are not recommended in the cot for babies under 12 months and should be used with supervision; put that in your listing. Sew every seam twice and weave ends in at least 5 cm. Say "embroidered face, no small parts" – a claim you can stand behind.

Materials & gauge

- **Yarn** DK (#3) 100% cotton (or a baby-safe certified blend), about 60 g – cream, sage, dusty pink or pale grey. Only the head is stuffed.
- **Hook** 3.5 mm (US E/4) for the blanket; use 3.0 mm for the head if your tension is loose.
- **Eyes / floss** None – the face is embroidered in dark brown or charcoal cotton floss, ends knotted inside.
- **Also** about 8 g fibre fill, tapestry needle, stitch marker.
- **Gauge** about 4.3 mm per stitch and 3.8 mm per round. Check on the blanket after Rnd 3: 9 dc along an edge should measure ~39 mm; narrower and the blanket comes out small.

How it comes together

The HEAD and EARS are worked in a continuous spiral (no joins, marker in the first stitch). The BLANKET is worked in JOINED rounds: each round closes with a slip stitch and the next begins with a turning chain – a different rhythm that lets the square grow out evenly. Work every stitch through both loops unless noted.

- 1 Magic ring & spiral** The head and each ear begin with a magic ring; pull the tail tight after round one.
- 2 The granny-square corner** Every blanket corner is (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) into one corner space. Those four corners make the piece square instead of round. Miss one corner group and the whole square pulls out of true – check all four at the end of every round.
- 3 The border round** One final round of single crochet around the edge with 3 sc into each corner space squares the edge and stops the blanket curling. Do not skip it.

Sizing the blanket

The square grows ~1.3 cm per side per round: 18 rounds ~23 cm, 20 rounds ~26 cm, 22 rounds ~28 cm. Add rounds to make a bigger lovey.

1. Head - a slightly flattened sphere

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	ears at R4-6
R5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	
R6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	(36)	full width
R7	sc in each st around	(36)	
R8	sc in each st around	(36)	face on R8-10
R9	sc in each st around	(36)	
R10	[4 sc, dec] x 6	(30)	
R11	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	stuff firmly
R12	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	
R13	[sc, dec] x 6	(12)	top up stuffing
R14	dec x 6	(6)	close

FO and close with the tail. The finished head is about 4.9 cm across and 5.3 cm tall. Stuff it **FIRMLY** – a soft head collapses when gripped and the face distorts.

2. Ears - long and floppy, make 2 (do not stuff)

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	[sc, inc] x 3	(9)	
R3	[2 sc, inc] x 3	(12)	
R4-8	sc in each st around (5 rnd)	(12)	
R9	[2 sc, dec] x 3	(9)	
R10	sc in each st around	(9)	
R11	[sc, dec] x 3	(6)	flatten, FO

Flatten and FO with a long tail. Sew to Rnds 4-6 of the head, about 10 stitches apart, pinching each base so it flops forward.

3. Blanket - joined granny-square rounds

Ch 4 and sl st to the first ch to form a ring.

Rnd 1: ch 3 (counts as first dc), 2 dc in the ring, [ch 2, 3 dc in the ring] x 3, ch 2, sl st to the ch-3 top. [12 dc, 4 corner spaces]

Rnd 2: sl st into the next corner space; ch 3, 2 dc in that space, ch 2, 3 dc in the same space (first corner); then (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) into each remaining corner space; sl st to close. [24 dc]

Rnds 3-20: into every corner space work (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc), and into every space along a side work 3 dc. Each round adds one 3-dc group to every side (+12 dc per round).

RND	TOTAL DC
R3	36
R5	60
R10	120
R15	180
R20	240 (60 dc per edge = ~26 cm)

Border: work one final round of sc all the way around – 1 sc into each dc and 3 sc into each corner space – then sl st and FO. At Rnd 20 that is 240 sc + 12 corner sc = 252 sc. This firms the edge and stops the square curling.



Open dc clusters and crisp (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) corners keep the square true round after round.

4. Face & assembly

Face (embroidery only): two small oval eyes about 8 stitches apart across Rnds 8-9, a small inverted-triangle nose centred between and below them, and a shallow Y for the mouth. KNOT every end inside the head and bury the tails before closing. Skip blush – chalk rubs off on bedding and is not washable.

Joining: centre the head over one corner of the square, overlapping the blanket by about 3 cm. Sew all the way around the base of the head, THEN sew it a second time – this is the only structural seam and it will be pulled, chewed and washed. Weave every end in at least 5 cm.

5. For your listing

- **Materials** 100% cotton, embroidered face, no safety eyes, no buttons, beads or removable parts.
- **Care** Machine wash cool on a gentle cycle inside a mesh bag; reshape while damp and dry flat. Do not tumble dry – it will felt and shrink.
- **Supervision** Comforters are not recommended in the cot for babies under 12 months; use with supervision.

Troubleshooting

- **Blanket curls / not square.** You skipped the sc border, or missed a (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) corner – check all four corners at the end of every round.
- **Came out too small / head flops.** Tighter than 4.3 mm/dc: go up a hook or add rounds (22 rounds = ~28 cm). Stuff the head firmly and sew the base seam twice.

Colorways: cream, sage, dusty pink, pale grey and butter yellow – neutrals outsell brights in the baby category.

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Safety reminder

Willow has NO safety eyes, buttons, beads or removable parts – the face is embroidered and floss ends are knotted inside the head. Even so she is not a tested toy (ASTM F963 / EN 71): do not claim "baby-safe". Comforters are not recommended in a cot for babies under 12 months and should be used with supervision; sew every seam twice and weave ends in at least 5 cm.

Happy crocheting!

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